

Carlos A. Silva

Environmental Economist

Edinburgh, UK

Phone: +44 7469 556 058 - Email: cas2002@hw.ac.uk

[Website](#) - [Google Scholar](#)

RESEARCH PROFILE

Environmental economist specialising in fisheries, marine conservation policy and sustainable development within socio-ecological systems. Experience designing and implementing stated preference surveys and mixed-method fieldwork in Latin America, and causal analysis for policy evaluation. Research integrates socio-economic analysis with ecosystem management and has informed conservation policy design, fishing regulations, and ecosystem accounting studies.

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Environmental economics, marine conservation policy, non-market valuation, stated preference methods, policy evaluation, causal inference.

EDUCATION

PhD Economics (expected Sep 2026), Heriot-Watt University

Thesis: Public acceptability and economic valuation of sustainable development policies

Supervisors: Claudia Aravena, Eoin McLaughlin

MSc Econometrics and Economics, University of York

Bachelor of Economics, ESPOL Polytechnic University

PUBLISHED PAPERS

- Artisanal fisheries provide essential food and nutrition on the Galapagos Islands (*joint with C. Viteri, S. Partelow, L. Kluger, M. Tanner, O. Estes, G. Rodriguez, M.J. Barragan*) ***Frontiers in Sustainable Food Systems***, 2026
- Dynamism of the housing rental market in Guayaquil (*joint with M. Zambrano-Monserrate, M. A. Ruano, R. Campoverde*) ***Empirical Economics***, 2022
- Urban green spaces and housing prices in developing countries: A Two-stage quantile spatial regression analysis. (*joint with M. Zambrano-Monserrate, M. Ruano, C. Yoong*) ***Forest Policy and Economics***, 2021
- The economic value of Natural Protected Areas in Ecuador (*joint with M. Zambrano-Monserrate, M. Ruano*) ***Ocean and Coastal Management***, 2018
- Testing environmental Kuznets curve hypothesis in Peru: The role of renewable electricity, petroleum and dry natural gas (*joint with Zambrano-Monserrate, M., J. Davalos, A. Zambrano, M. Ruano*) ***Renewable and Sustainable Energy Reviews***, 2018

WORKING PAPERS

- Public acceptability of conservation entrance fees: How does reallocating revenues shift support before and after policy implementation? (*joint with C. Aravena, E. McLaughlin, C. Viteri*) [PhD Paper](#)
- Net benefits of stricter conservation policies in the Galapagos Marine Reserve (*joint with C. Viteri, A. Martinez-Cruz, C. Aravena*)
- The Effect of Temporary Alcohol Bans on Domestic Violence, Road Safety and Health (*joint with Javid Karimli*)

RESEARCH EMPLOYMENT

Environmental Economist

Charles Darwin Foundation, 2020–Present

- Led economic valuation studies of ecosystem services and marine conservation policies using stated preference methods.
- Contributed socio-economic analysis to interdisciplinary conservation, ecosystem accounting, and fisheries modelling studies.
- Designed and implemented stakeholder fieldwork across fisheries and tourism sectors.
- Advised policymakers on marine zoning redesign and fisheries closures.
- Secured research funding and contributed to develop interdisciplinary project grant proposals.
- Delivered capacity-building workshops for local stakeholders and authorities.
- Integrated fisheries traceability system implementation with business initiatives.

Research Assistant

ESPOL Polytechnic University, 2019–2020

- Co-authored peer-reviewed publications and policy outputs.
- Produced economic bulletins on Asia-Pacific economies.
- Organised academic workshops and seminars.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Tutor Edinburgh Business School – Heriot-Watt University

- Tutorials and grading in Contemporary Economic Policy and Institutions.

Teaching Assistant MBA Program – ESPAE Business School

- Tutorials in microeconomics including market equilibrium, taxation, and industrial organisation. Assessment design and grading.

Teaching Assistant ESPOL Polytechnic University

- Tutorials and exam preparation support for Econometrics I.

WORK IN PROGRESS

- Effects of Policy and Payment Consequentiality in Stated Preferences Valuation (*joint with C. Aravena*)
- Displaced from the Ocean: New Realities of Small-Scale Fisheries and the Surge of Illicit Economies in Ecuador (*joint with C. Paez, C. Viteri*)

POLICY BRIEFS AND REPORTS

- One year after the adjustment of Galapagos entrance fees: Are there changes in tourist demand? [Policy Brief] Heriot-Watt University, Charles Darwin Foundation, December 2025 [PDF](#)
- Adjustment of entry fees to the Galapagos National Park – Tourist attitudes and perceptions [Policy Brief] Heriot-Watt University, Charles Darwin Foundation, March 2025 [PDF](#)
- Ecosystem Accounts for the Insular Economic Exclusive Zone of Ecuador [Technical Report No. 1] Charles Darwin Foundation. Puerto Ayora, Galápagos, Ecuador, 2025 [PDF](#)

POLICY IMPACT

- Policy brief uptake: evidence used by the Galapagos National Park Directorate in monitoring the impact of entrance fees changes on tourism demand.
- Technical advisor in the participatory redesign process of Galapagos Marine Reserve zoning.
- Technical advisor in the development of the Galapagos Fisheries Calendar 2023–2028.

GRANTS

Rufford Small Grant for Nature Conservation (£6000), 2024–2025. Principal investigator coordinating project implementation and field activities. [Project page](#)

CONFERENCES PRESENTATIONS

- Displaced from the Ocean: New Realities of Small-Scale Fisheries and the Surge of Illicit Economies in Ecuador. World Small-scale Fisheries Congress, 2026.
- Revenue reallocation increases support for conservation entrance fees: Evidence before and after a fee change. LAERE Congress, 2025.
- Red-MOPTO: Integrating socio-economic research for the conservation of the ETP Marine Corridor. UN Ocean Decade Conference, 2024.

REFEREE SERVICE

- Journal of Environmental Studies and Sciences
- Antropología: Cuadernos de Investigación

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Econometrics: discrete choice models, spatial econometrics, panel data models

Software: R, Stata, QGIS

Methods: stated preference valuation, survey design, impact evaluation, differences-in-differences, qualitative analysis.

LANGUAGES

Spanish (native), English (fluent).

REFERENCES

Name: Claudia Aravena

Position: Associate Professor

Institution: Heriot-Watt University

Contact: Available upon request

Name: Eoin McLaughlin

Position: Professor

Institution: Heriot-Watt University

Contact: Available upon request

Name: Jorge Ramirez-Gonzalez

Position: Senior Biologist - Co-PI Sustainable Fisheries

Institution: Charles Darwin Foundation

Contact: Available upon request